Kangdi Liu

Speech, Learning, and the Brain (SLaB) Lab
Division of Humanities
The Hong Kong University of Science and Technology
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EDUCATION

The Hong Kong University of Science and Technology (HKUST)	Sep. 2023 - present
Division of Humanities (HUMA)	MPhil / PhD
Linguistics	GPA: 4.3/4.3
Nankai University (NKU)	Sep. 2020 - Jun. 2023
College of Chinese Language and Culture	MA
Linguistics and Applied Linguistics	GPA: 91.85/100 (Ranking: 1/25)
Northeast Normal University (NENU)	Sep. 2016 - Jun. 2020
Faculty of Arts	BA
Chinese Language and Literature	GPA: 91.49/100 (Ranking: 2/119)

PUBLICATIONS

Refereed Journal Articles

Liang, L., **Liu, K.**, Liao, Z., & Wang, J. (2025). A diachronic study of individual tone variation. *Linguistic Sciences*, *24*(6), 621-634. [CSSCI]

Liu, K., Liang, L., & Qin, Z. (2024). The role of acoustic cues in the production of checked-unchecked merging tones from the Qixian Jin dialect. *The Journal of the Acoustical Society of America Express Letters*, *4*(12), 125202.

Liu, K., Chen, Y., & Liang, L. (2021). Gender variation of entering tone in Tongcheng dialect, *Experimental Linguistics*, *10*(2), 64-68.

Refereed Conference Proceedings

Liu, K., & Liang, L. (2023). Usage-based second language acquisition for verb-resultative construction in Modern Chinese. In J. Zheng, J. Yin, & M. Hu (Eds.), *New Ideas and Explorations in International Chinese Education: Proceedings of the 16th International Conference on Chinese Language Pedagogy (ICCLP-16)* (pp. 118-127). Beijing: Foreign Language Teaching and Research Press.

PRESENTATIONS

Liu, K., Feng, Y., & Qin, Z. (2025). Tone learning in aging: an encoding-enhanced training paradigm to promote overnight consolidation. Poster presentation at the *6th Joint Meeting of the Acoustical Society of America and the Acoustical Society of Japan*, Honolulu, Hawaii, USA.

Liu, K., Feng, Y., & Qin, Z. (2025). Extended pre-sleep training reinforces memory consolidation of Cantonese tones in older adults. Oral presentation at the *Joint Postgraduate Student Symposium on Language, Culture and Cognition*, Hong Kong: The Hong Kong Polytechnic

University.

Liu, K., Feng, Y., & Qin, Z. (2024). Does prior knowledge benefit Mandarin-speaking older adults' memory consolidation in Cantonese tone learning? Poster presentation at the *Architectures and Mechanisms for Language Processing Asia (AMLaP Asia-2024)*, Singapore: National University of Singapore.

Liu, K., Feng, Y., & Qin, Z. (2024). Prior knowledge benefits older adults' tonal consolidation through talker generalization. Poster presentation at the *186th Meeting of the Acoustical Society of America (ASA)*, Ottawa, Canada.

Liang, L., & **Liu, K.** (2023). The new trend of tone evolution in Taiyuan dialect: Evidence from acoustic and perceptual studies. Oral presentation at the *29th Annual Conference of the International Association of Chinese Linguistics (IACL-29)*, Macau: Macau University of Science and Technology.

Liu, K. (2022). A study on the semantic acquisition of verbs in verb-resultative construction. Oral presentation at the *10th International Symposium on Chinese Function Words and Teaching Chinese as a Foreign Language* (Awarded the Excellent Paper for Young Researchers), Shanghai: Shanghai Normal University.

Liu, K., & Liang, L. (2022). The evolution of entering tones in Qixian dialect. Oral presentation at the *34th North American Conference on Chinese Linguistics (NACCL-34)*, Bloomington: Indiana University, USA.

Liu, K., & Liang, L. (2022). The acoustic realization and evolutionary trend of entering tones in Qixian dialect. Oral presentation at the *28th Annual Conference of the International Association of Chinese Linguistics (IACL-28)*, Hong Kong: The Chinese University of Hong Kong.

Liang, L., **Liu, K.,** & Wang, J. (2022). A longitudinal study of individual tone variation. Oral presentation at the *28th Annual Conference of the International Association of Chinese Linguistics (IACL-28)*, Hong Kong: The Chinese University of Hong Kong.

Liang, L., **Liu, K.,** & Hou, W. (2021). Synchronic tonal variation in Taiyuan Dialect. Oral presentation at the *14th Phonetic Conference of China (PCC-2021)*, Lanzhou: Northwest Minzu University.

GRANTS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

Research Grants

Strengthened Funding Support for HKPFS Awardees 2025 - 2026
Supported by the University Grants Committee of Hong Kong

HUMA Postgraduate Research Grant 2023 - present
Supported by the Division of Humanities, HKUST

NKU Postgraduate Student Research Training Project 2021
Awarded the Excellent Project by NKU (award rate: around 10%, 11 out of 91 funded projects)

Travel Grants

Research Travel Grant (HKUST) 2024/2025
Student Transportation Subsidy (Acoustical Society of America) 2024
International Conference Travel Grant (NKU) 2023

Honors, Awards & Scholarships

Hong Kong PhD Fellowship 2025/2026/2027
(The Research Grants Council of Hong Kong)
Outstanding Thesis Award (Linguistic Society of Hong Kong) 2025
Redbird PhD Award (HKUST) 2025
Dr. Charles Chan Postgraduate Scholarship (HKUST) 2024
Excellent Student (Summer School for Postgraduate Students in Jiangsu Province) 2024
Postgraduate Studentship (HKUST) 2023/2024
Excellent Paper for Young Researchers 2022
(International Symposium on Chinese Function Words and Teaching Chinese as a Foreign Language)
Gongneng Scholarship (NKU) 2021/2022
First-class Award in the Paper Competition of the College (NKU) 2021
Scholarship for the Excellent First-year Postgraduate Student (NKU) 2021
Excellent Graduate (NENU) 2020
National Scholarship (Ministry of Education, People's Republic of China) 2019
Excellent Volunteer (NENU) 2019
Scholarship for Academic Specialty (NENU) 2018
Presidential Scholarship (NENU) 2017/2018/2020
Excellent Student (NENU) 2017/2018/2019/2020

RESEARCH

Project of the HKUST-Southeastern University (SEU) Joint Research Seed Fund 2026 - 2027
(HKUST PI: Prof. Quentin Qin; SEU PI: Prof. Yu Chen)
Member of the Joint Research Team

Project of the National Social Science Fund of China (PI: Prof. Lei Liang) Fall 2024
Research Assistant (manuscript preparation)

Project of the Research Grants Council of Hong Kong (PI: Prof. Quentin Qin) Summer 2024
Research Assistant (data collection and analysis)

Project of the Institute for Emerging Market Studies (PI: Prof. Quentin Qin) Winter 2024
Research Assistant (data collection and analysis)

TEACHING

HUMA 2400 Approaches to Humanities in China Studies (HKUST) Spring 2024/2025/2026
Teaching Assistant

HUMA 1676 Marco Polo and His Book of Travels (HKUST) Fall 2025
Teaching Assistant

HUMA 1010 Introduction to Language (HKUST) Fall 2024
Teaching Assistant

International Chinese Education (NENU) 2018 - 2019
Preparatory education for international students heading to universities in China
Teaching Assistant

SERVICE & VOLUNTEERING EXPERIENCE

HUMA Research Postgraduate Student Representative (HKUST) 2024 - present
Student Assistant (International Cooperation and Exchange Office of NKU) 2023
Social Practice Activity in the Summer Vacation (NKU) 2021
Academic Representative of the Postgraduate Student Class Committee (NKU) 2020 - 2023

MEMBERSHIPS

The Linguistic Society of Hong Kong (LSHK) 2025 - present
Student member

Acoustical Society of America (ASA) 2024 - present
Student member

International Association of Chinese Linguistics (IACL) 2022 - 2023
Student member

SKILLS

Phonetics: Praat; VoiceSauce
Psychology: E-prime; Psychopy; Paradigm; DmDX; EEG data acquisition
Data preprocessing and analysis: R; Python; MATLAB (EEGLAB, SPM); SPSS
Language: Mandarin (native); English (IELTS 7); Cantonese (beginner)